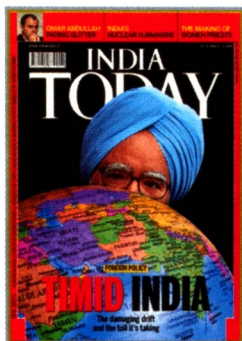


Timid India

AUGUST 3, 2009

The prime minister's total surrender at Sharm el-Sheikh or allowing Washington to be the arbiter of India's nuclear independence shows the extent to which the Government will compromise on national interest.



“ Bringing Balochistan into the picture and de-linking action on terror from the composite dialogue process will only help Pakistan create problems for India at international fora. ”

M.C. JOSHI, *Lucknow*

Power Failure

It is evident that India has failed to be assertive on matters related to cross-border terrorism (“Timid India”, August 3). The United States, on the other hand, has its own game-plan in not pressing Pakistan to book the perpetrators. We need to chalk out our own strategy in tackling various problems while confronting our neighbour.
K.R. SAKUNTHALA, *Mysore*

With the inclusion of Balochistan and exclusion of Pakistan-sponsored terrorism in India, Prime Minister Manmohan Singh gave far too much than was warranted by the situation. While Indian diplomats are offering lame explanations like poor drafting, Pakistan has lost no time in mounting a



Stumbling Scion

Ever since Omar Abdullah took over as the chief minister, things have only gone from bad to worse in Jammu and Kashmir (“Fading Glitter”, August 3). This shows that Omar is immature and not really cut out to head a sensitive state where the ground realities are still grim with separatists, fundamentalists and opportunists exploiting the situation to their advantage.

K.R. SRINIVASAN, *Secunderabad*

The Shopian rape and murder case and the Bomai and Baramulla firings might have hampered Omar Abdullah's image, but he is the ray of light that Jammu and Kashmir needs. And the behaviour of PDP President Mehbooba Mufti in the assembly only shows the party's frustration after the defeat in the Lok Sabha elections.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

full-blown diplomatic offensive, alleging an Indian hand in the uprising in Balochistan. This is a diplomatic victory for Pakistan against India.

R.J. KHURANA, *Bhopal*

Nuclear Punch

The launch of India's nuclear-powered submarine, INS *Arihant*, for sea trials will give new teeth of unimaginable proportions to the Indian Navy (“Deep Impact”, August 3). This will also mean a technological leap for India. This underwater vessel will prove to be an undersea platform for launching nuclear-tipped missiles on enemy targets in every possible direction.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

Ruling the Roost

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Mayawati's ten-

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